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a16z's Recommendations for the National AI Action Plan

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This week, a16z shared our recommendations with the White House Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) for how the United States can implement a competitiveness agenda that will enable it to continue to lead the world in AI development. Little Tech has an important role to play in strengthening America's ability to compete in AI in the future, just as it has been a driving force of American technological innovation historically. We shared our comments as part of the OSTP's [request for information](#) as it gathers policy ideas to inform and develop a new AI Action Plan.

AI has the promise to transform our world and lives for the better. AI-powered services could help doctors create new medicines and treatments to improve health outcomes, enhance how students learn in school and at home, improve transportation infrastructure, and the list goes on. As we've seen throughout history, from Edison and Ford to Hughes and Lockheed, [startups are the vanguard of American technological leadership](#). This AI innovation cycle is no different. Consider, for instance, that [more than 5,000 new AI startups](#) in the United States were funded between 2013 and 2023 alone. And all of the recent, cutting edge products in AI have come from startups, not Big Tech incumbents.

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United States, or by a foreign adversary like China. To outcompete other countries and win the AI race, the United States must recognize that entrepreneurship is the cornerstone of AI leadership and ensure Little Tech has a fair shot to build, compete, and thrive.

2. Regulate harms, not AI model development.

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This is analogous to the approach taken in earlier eras of computing, for example, when the federal government established a [National Center for Supercomputing Applications at University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign](#), which resulted in the development of the first web browser. At the same time, the United States should make investments to strengthen talent pipelines through workforce development initiatives. This could include AI literacy and training programs or public-private initiatives to support new jobs created for the AI

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